

# MOTH ORCHID

## *Phalaenopsis*

This is my favorite type of orchid. In Greek, *Phalaenopsis* means “moth-like,” which is apt, because this plant’s flowers look like moths in flight. Flowering spikes grow from the tonguelike foliage, bearing many flower buds that open in stages right to the tip. An easy plant to keep, it will clean your air and, if fed and watered, flower for months.

“I’m a champion bloomer and expert air purifier.”

## Help me thrive



### POSITION

Likes bright, filtered light and a warm centrally heated room of at least 19°C (66°F). Move to a shadier spot during summer.



### POTTING

Repot in spring into the next size up in a free-draining orchid mix when it has outgrown its pot or been in the same soil for 2 or more years.



### GROWTH RATE

Plants can grow to anything from 6in (15cm) to 3¼ft (1m) tall and to a width of 8–12in (20–30cm), at varying speeds.



### CARE

Water only once the soil begins to dry out and feed every 2 weeks with a liquid orchid fertilizer when in growth. Reduce both in winter.



### I’ll remove toxins

I can help maintain healthy breathing functions by reducing formaldehyde released from composite wood products, as well as xylene and toluene, which are used in paints, paint thinners, and varnishes. Scientific studies have shown me to be one of the best air-purifying houseplants.



### Be mindful of me

Keep my leaves clear of dust by wiping them with a damp cloth—this will allow maximum light to reach my foliage as well as keep me looking my best. Since I am native to Southeast Asia and the Philippines, I also like humidity, so mist me regularly with rainwater, please.

